

Organizational Commitment of IT Faculty in Non-Accredited SUCs: Age, Academic Rank, and Institutional Engagement

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ABSTRACT

This article isolates the organizational-commitment findings from Lagon's study of 154 IT faculty members in non-accredited state-university and college IT programs in Region VI. The overall commitment mean was 4.6748 (SD = .3265), interpreted as Very High. All demographic and institutional subgroups were also classified as Very High. However, significant differences were reported by age ($t = -2.618$, $p = .010$) and academic rank (Kruskal-Wallis chi-square = 11.297, $p = .004$), while differences by sex, educational qualification, length of teaching experience, and school location were not significant. Older faculty and higher-ranked faculty showed higher descriptive commitment scores. The paper discusses these results in relation to faculty retention, career progression, recognition, and institutional support without treating age or rank as proven causal determinants of commitment.

Keywords: *organizational commitment, faculty engagement, academic rank, age, IT faculty, SUCs, higher education*

INTRODUCTION

Commitment in the original dissertation was defined as attachment to and identification with the organization, involvement in it, and the desire to remain a member. The study used an adapted 30-item commitment instrument and a five-point scale. The source treated commitment as one of the faculty-related conditions that may matter for accreditation.

This manuscript focuses on the pattern of commitment by faculty characteristics. Its purpose is not to claim that older age or higher academic rank causes greater commitment, but to identify which group differences were statistically visible in the source analysis.

Overall and Subgroup Commitment

Grouping Category Mean SD Interpretation

Entire group	154 respondents	4.6748	.3265	Very High
Age	30 and below	4.6123	.3440	Very High
Age	Above 30	4.7479	.2904	Very High
Sex	Male	4.6666	.3166	Very High
Sex	Female	4.6884	.3446	Very High
Education	Master's degree	4.7210	.2957	Very High
Education	Baccalaureate degree	4.6565	.3371	Very High
Experience	Above 8 years	4.7688	.2748	Very High
Experience	8 years and below	4.6418	.3377	Very High
Rank	Part-time instructor	4.5813	.3491	Very High
Rank	Instructor	4.7384	.2965	Very High
Rank	Professor	4.8108	.2217	Very High

Inferential Pattern

Variable Statistic p value Decision

Age	t = -2.618	.010	Significant
Sex	t = -0.402	.688	Not significant

Educational qualification $t = -1.073 .285$ Not significant
Length of teaching experience $t = -0.834 .406$ Not significant

Academic rank Kruskal-Wallis chi-square = 11.297 .004
Significant

School location Kruskal-Wallis chi-square = 3.860 .570
Not significant

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Age and academic rank are the two characteristics for which the source reports significant commitment differences. Older faculty had a higher mean than younger faculty, and the mean-rank pattern increased from part-time instructor (64.21) to instructor (86.41) to professor (95.23). The location result was not significant, indicating that provincial placement did not produce statistically different commitment distributions within the source analysis.

The experience variable deserves careful interpretation. Although faculty with more than eight years of teaching had a higher descriptive mean, the inferential test was not significant. This illustrates why years of experience and age should not be treated as interchangeable predictors.

Institutional Interpretation

A management interpretation of the findings is that commitment may be connected to career positioning and long-term organizational integration. Faculty who have reached higher ranks may have accumulated stronger institutional ties, responsibilities, recognition, and professional identity. Older faculty may likewise have longer histories with their institutions. However, the

dissertation's cross-sectional design cannot determine the direction of influence.

The source recommends helping younger and part-time instructors pursue graduate study and progress toward permanent academic rank through scholarships and financial assistance. The commitment findings provide a rationale for testing whether career-development opportunities can strengthen retention and engagement, but such an intervention would require a new longitudinal or experimental evaluation.

Practical Faculty-Management Framework

Observed source pattern Possible institutional response
Evidence needed next

Very high commitment overall Preserve supportive policies and recognition systems Periodic commitment monitoring

Lower mean among younger faculty Mentoring, onboarding, career mapping Longitudinal retention and engagement data

Lower mean among part-time instructors Pathways to permanent rank and graduate study Track promotion, turnover, and commitment over time

Campus-level qualitative evidence

No significant location difference Use institution-wide commitment principles with local adaptation

CONCLUSION

The IT faculty members in the source study reported very high organizational commitment. The statistically meaningful differences were concentrated in age and academic rank, not sex, education, teaching experience,

or school location. These findings are best used to generate faculty-development and retention questions rather than deterministic claims. Career progression and structured support for younger and part-time faculty are logical areas for future evaluation.

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